

Assess AI Autonomy Levels in Your Organization

Scenario

You're the newly appointed AI Governance Officer at a mid-sized financial services company. The organization has been rapidly adopting AI systems across multiple departments, but there's no consistent framework for assessing the level of autonomy these systems possess. Your first task is to conduct an autonomy assessment of three different AI systems currently in use.

Your Mission

Evaluate the autonomy levels of three AI systems and develop recommendations for governance approaches based on your assessment.

Your Tasks

1. System Classification (5 minutes)

You have three AI systems to evaluate:

System A: A fraud detection system that analyzes transaction patterns and automatically flags suspicious activities. It can adjust its sensitivity based on emerging fraud patterns and can temporarily block transactions deemed high-risk.

System B: A customer service chatbot that handles routine inquiries, escalates complex issues to humans, and can learn from each interaction to improve its responses.

System C: An investment advisory system that analyzes market data, creates personalized investment recommendations, and can automatically rebalance portfolios based on risk tolerance and market conditions.

For each system, determine its autonomy level (Reactive, Adaptive, Autonomous Agent, or Agentic AI) and provide a brief justification.

2. Risk Assessment (3 minutes)

For each system, identify the primary ethical and operational risks associated with its level of autonomy. Consider:

→ What decisions does the system make independently?

→ What are the potential consequences of incorrect or biased decisions?

→ How transparent are the system's decision-making processes?

3. Governance Recommendations (2 minutes)

Based on your autonomy assessment, recommend appropriate governance approaches for each system. Consider:

What level of human oversight is needed?

What monitoring and auditing procedures should be in place?

How should accountability be structured?

Completion Criteria:

- Clear classification of each system's autonomy level with justification
- Identification of key risks for each system
- Practical governance recommendations tailored to each autonomy level
- Clear reasoning connecting autonomy level to governance approach
- Submit your assessment as a structured analysis covering all three systems.

In the next step, you'll engage in a guided conversation to refine your assessment and explore alternative approaches to AI governance based on your analysis.